United Nations, in order to contribute to the maintenance of international peace and security, should undertake to make available to the Security Council, on its call and in accordance with a special agreement or agreements, armed forces, assistance and facilities, including rights of passage, necessary for the purpose of maintaining international peace and security. Article 46 provides that plans for the application of armed force shall be made by the Security Council with the assistance of the Military Staff Committee which shall be established under Article 47 to advise and assist the Security Council on all questions relating to the Security Council's military requirements for the maintenance of international peace and security, the employment and command of forces placed at its disposal, the regulation of armaments, and possible disarmament.

The Military Staff Committee under the Security Council shall consist of the Chiefs of Staff of the permanent members of the Security Council or their representatives. Any member of the United Nations not permanently represented on the Committee shall be invited by the Committee to be associated with it when the efficient discharge of the Committee's responsibilities requires the participation of that member in its work. The Military Staff Committee shall be responsible for the strategic direction of any armed forces placed at the disposal of the Security Council. Questions relating to the command of such forces shall be worked out subsequently. The Committee, with the authorization of the Security Council and after consultation with appropriate regional agencies, may establish regional sub-committees.

Exceptions prevail to these functions of Security Council relating to peace and security. According to Article 51, nothing in the present Charter shall impair the inherent right of individual or collective self-defence if an armed attack occurs against a member of the United Nations, until the Security Council has taken measures necessary to maintain international peace and security. The measures taken by members in the exercise of this right of self-defence shall be immediately reported to the Security Council and shall not in any way affect the authority and responsibility of the Security Council, under the present Charter, to take at any time such action as it deems necessary in order to maintain or restore international peace